

dents. He was about to graduate from seminary and had sold his latest business for \$40,000. The only difference between Jeremy and the vast majority of other students was that his father started him on sound biblical principles of handling money at an early age. It's as the proverb says, "Train up a child in the way he should go, even when he is old he will not depart from it" (Proverbs 22:6).

21 TRAINING CHILDREN AGES 11-16

At ages 11-16, you need to increase your children's level of understanding about finances. There are a few basic principles that parents need to concentrate on during this transition period to adulthood.

(1) *There's no such thing in God's economy as an allowance.* An allowance implies money given by a parent but disassociated from performance. Look around and you'll see the product of "allowing" parents at any university in America today. What you really need to teach your teenagers is responsibility. As the Apostle Paul said, "For even when we were with you, we used to give you this order: if anyone will not work, neither let him eat" (2 Thessalonians 3:10). Obviously, you don't want to withhold food from a 16-year-old. But when it comes to your car, yes.

So many times parents indulge because they love, when indulgence is the exact opposite of real love; *real* love does what is best for the other person, regardless of the difficulties for you.

It's an interesting phenomenon that children grow up resenting a parent who was too harsh, but they also resent a parent who was too lenient. I have heard many mothers say they don't understand why their children resent them later in life when all they ever did was give, give, give. That is *exactly* the problem. They buffered their children rather than trained them.

(2) *Have a very strict performance code for work your teen-*